

Waldo County

Adler, Robert Michael

BELFAST

I would be honored to serve as a delegate to this important nominating convention. I have worked in Democratic Party efforts over 55 years in three states where I have resided. I am a resident of Belfast since 2014, a member of WCDC, and have served as the election warden for Belfast wards 1&2 since being elected in 2023. My current term runs through 2027.

Antoon Lucas, Deborah

NORTHPORT

EVERY Citizen of Maine deserves a Senator that ALWAYS represents their BEST interests. Susan Collins has FAILED that responsibility. Rather than complaining or wringing our hands, we've got the important work to do now to elect our Democratic nominee to defeat Collins. I'm ready to do that important work, as a Delegate & as a Citizen, to ensure that process becomes a positive reality. Thanks for considering me to be a Delegate.

Bates, Gregory H

MONROE

Mainers value hard work. Our task is to nominate a candidate who can convince enough people who voted for Susan Collins in the past to vote for our Democrat in November. All while holding fast to our progressive agenda. As delegates, we must convince whoever our nominee is to champion the common ground between the left, center and right: manufacturing jobs for people who want to work hard. To win, Democrats must win on the economy. We need to make the case: In the world's richest country, there is no excuse for people having to scramble to make ends meet. We must create enough manufacturing jobs so that those who value hard work can work hard. Every candidate mentions the economy. But if we want to swing voters, we must put creating millions of manufacturing jobs at the center of our campaign. Second, to win, the nominee must broadcast concrete policies they will fight for. Progressive, centrist or rightwing, they must be brief and clear. Think of Mamdani: when he campaigned in NYC, voters were so familiar they would shout his planks at him from across the street—free buses, freeze the rent! Our candidate, from whatever political stripe and whatever their positions, must be as clear—and as memorable. We must show we know what voters want better than Collins does—and then deliver. I will work with fellow delegates to help candidates champion manufacturing jobs with powerful policies everyone can rally around.

Immigrant/New Mainer

Beckford, Peter Daniel

LIBERTY

I would like to serve as a delegate because I am totally committed to seeing that Susan Collins is replaced by a Democratic Senator. I have been volunteering for the Platner campaign and want to use the energy he inspired to complete the ultimate goal of replacing Susan Collins and all she represents as a Republican Senator. I want to see Trump's and his fellow Republicans' attacks on U.S. democracy stymied by a Democrat controlled Senate and House. I want to see ICE defunded, I want to see taxes raised on the rich and corporations, and I want benefits restored to vulnerable populations. I want to see progress on creating a national health care service. And I want to see offensive weapons sales to Israel ended. Maine can help our country by running a candidate against Susan Collins who can express the anger and capture the enthusiasm that Platner brought to the race. I will volunteer for whatever candidate is nominated, knock doors, signs, literature, donate, and I'll write the letter to the editor that will make my fellow Mainers consider that it's time to usher Collins out the door. We need a candidate like Troy Jackson who knows what it's like to labor and be ripped off by capitalist greed, a candidate who is proximate to people who are working too hard for too little, with too little time for themselves. Jackson is best positioned to capture that grassroots enthusiasm and defeat Collins.

Bernstein, Stephen Mark

BELFAST

In a nutshell, with your input I will try to select the candidate who, most importantly in this election, can throw the biggest political punch for defeating Collins and her support of Trump's Fascist government; corporate and billionaire Kleptocracy; and destruction of democracy – a candidate who has a strong commitment to human and labor rights, reproductive rights, and the diversity of our country. A candidate's ideas and commitment to affordability are of critical importance. I have great respect for the wisdom of my fellow community members and will welcome the input of all about the candidates and their platforms. I'm a good listener.

Bird, Michele Cambridge

BELFAST

Since moving to Maine twelve years ago, I have worked for the Democrats in every election - I have gathered signatures, written hundreds of postcards, knocked on countless doors throughout Waldo County - and I am a member of the Waldo County Democrats, serving on the DEIB committee. Like so many Waldo County voters, I have been inspired and motivated by the progressive, people-powered movement that has been growing in Maine for the last ten months. As a delegate, I will support the will of those voters and the principles of that movement: affordable health care, support for labor, opposition to forever wars. The past ten days have been tumultuous for Maine Democrats, and emotions have been running high - sorrow, anger, despondency. I believe we now have a unique opportunity to reset and feel hopeful. I am excited and optimistic about that opportunity. If we refrain

from finger-pointing, if we channel our emotions in a positive direction, if we come together with a common purpose, we can defeat Susan Collins. While as a delegate I will vote for the person I believe best represents the will of Waldo County voters, I will wholeheartedly support our eventual nominee and immediately volunteer for their campaign. I am retired and have the time and the energy to make defeating Susan Collins my job from now until November.

Blackford, Catherine

ISLESBORO

I am running for Delegate because I believe I can help Maine Dems come together behind a new candidate for Senate who will carry forward the progressive ideas that resoundingly triumphed in the primary and defeat Susan Collins. I have spent the last six years fighting for progressive policies in Maine. I co-led the campaign for paid family and medical leave. I have fought against corporate control of housing, for mobile home park residents, and for tenants' rights. I have fought for increasing union jobs, universal access to affordable childcare, and making the wealthy pay their fair share in taxes. I am deeply committed to creating a society where everyone has what they need and no one is left behind. To me, that means fighting like hell this fall for a candidate who supports universal healthcare, paying care providers what they are truly worth, abolishing ICE, tribal sovereignty and land back, restorative justice, strong public schools, and investing in the infrastructure our local communities need to meet this moment. I have devoted my entire career to better connecting real people with decision-makers, especially the people most excluded from designing policies and implementing them. I strongly believe this is the key to better outcomes for all of us, that truly meet people's needs, while developing the skills and relationships to reinvigorate our democracy. These are the values I will hold as your delegate and I will strive to represent during the Convention. I ask for your vote.

Blanchard, Andre Marquette

SEARSPORT

I would like to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I believed (up until the rape allegation) that Graham Platner, a solid progressive Democrat, like I am, with a progressive anti-oligarchy message, would have finally defeated Senator Susan Collins in November. Now we have to select a replacement ASAP from an excellent field of progressive Democrats so that our chosen candidate can begin campaigning, to pick up where Graham left us, to soundly defeat Senator Collins who has been and continues to be supportive of the Trump Administration, including her vote to fund DHS/ICE with an additional \$70 billion in June. This funding prompted a new wave of activities by ICE such as the murder of Johan Sebastián Durán Guerrero, a 26-year-old family man from Colombia, who was authorized to work in the United States. We need to nominate a candidate who will bring DHS/ICE under control and even shut this rogue federal police force down altogether by defunding them as soon as possible. DHS is no longer the Department of Homeland Security whose mission statement is "to safeguard the American people, our homeland, and our values with honor and integrity." It is now the Department of Homeland Terrorism who murders U.S. Citizens (Renee

Good and Alex Pretti) and our legal immigrants (like Johan Guerrero) with no repercussions and no oversight by Congress. ICE OUT NOW!

Bourg, Jean Louise

UNITY

It is possible that we can defeat Susan Collins in November if we pick a nominee who is aligned with the progressive platform that received huge support in the primary. As a delegate i would support such a candidate. The movement that began with Platner can continue to work enthusiastically for a November win. I have never been a delegate before, but our current crisis of national leadership has made this Maine election for US senate the place I want to put my energy.

Bowe, Linda

BELFAST

I believe sincerely that Nirav Shah has ALL the qualities we need for a smart, compassionate, US senator. He provided excellent, life-saving leadership to Maine during COVID, saving hundreds of citizens from illness and death. He is a highly moral person, a quality needed so badly in our current state of affairs.

Bradstreet, Amy Beth

PALERMO

I'm a 55-year old disabled woman, as such, my politics begin with disability rights and are firmly socialist. I'm a lifelong Maine voter and Democrat, graduate of UMaine as a Pell Grant recipient, daughter of a gay man and mother to a trans abortion worker. My childhood was shaped by food and housing insecurity in both small Hancock County communities and Lewiston-Auburn. I've voted for the Democrat against Collins every time. I did not rank or vote for Platner because of his unsuitability for office, but the platform was otherwise one I mostly support. I feel I offer a unique perspective of one who has lived, and continues to live, marginalization. We cannot allow Collins to continue to feed the fires of systemic oppression and fascism. We need support a candidate that is focused on protecting Mainers and all people, in the US and anywhere. We need a Maine senator that fights for the inherent worth and dignity of all; one who fights for government funded healthcare, for bodily autonomy, for reproductive rights, for privacy, for the environment, for education, for the disabled, for abolition, and our Constitution. In whatever capacity I can, as a delegate, or not, I will continue to advocate for our candidate, to help others wade through the noise, to educate when needed, and campaign to the best of my ability. Maine can continue to lead the Good Fight by electing a Democrat to replace Collins. We must.

Disability

Bradstreet, Stuart

PALERMO

As a parent of a trans person, and partner to a disabled person, I am very motivated to ensure we have the most progressive candidate possible to defeat Susan Collins. Her recent actions to remove reproductive rights from everyone and to take food and healthcare away from thousands of Mainers are reprehensible. We must quickly select the strongest candidate to win and push back against the widespread corruption of this Administration. I would volunteer to get out the vote for our new candidate; we need to motivate not only Democrats but also Independents drawn to Platner's campaign. While they are unable to participate in this nominating process, they will help decide who wins in November. To defeat Collins, I will help select a candidate who will build on the enthusiasm of the existing campaign platform. We need a Senator who will fight for the people of Maine, with broad appeal to women, to break that voting block away from Collins. We also need to counter any future impact of Washington DC Senators' actions on Maine's Democratic primary. The Senator from New York pressing Mills to run didn't help Maine select the best candidate to remove Collins. And endorsements by Senators from New England states, before our primary was complete, further amplified the chaos and the mess we now need to clean up. I would help the party build rules for Senate candidates to match the sentiments of our Party President: leave us alone, we know how to do this.

Broderick, Donna

SEARSMONT

If chosen as a delegate, I will listen to and research each and every candidate to understand their priorities, campaign platform, and previous track record. I will support the candidate who most closely aligns with the components of the Platner campaign that brought so many voters to the primary in support of him. Of primary importance to me are candidates who believe healthcare is a human right, are willing to fight at the federal level to make housing more affordable, believe that billionaires and corporations should be fairly taxed, want to end open-ended US military engagement abroad, want to abolish ICE, and who consider energy and our climate crisis in all policy decision making. If selected as a delegate, I will earnestly seek out the candidate I believe best represents these values and can defeat Susan Collins.

Brooks, Bonnie-Jean

STOCKTON SPRINGS

I want to influence every delegate to send Dr. Shah to Congress. His platform, passion, performance support our constitutional principles! Maine needs every law abiding immigrant who wants to be part of the American dream! I will go Toe to toe with supporters of Collins based on many years of experience in the disability and civil rights movements. Op-eds, door knocking, signs, driving,

speaking. I'll do what it takes! We must regain civility, abide by the rule of law, and bring back peace to our country!

Brown, Elise Sheila

LIBERTY

I would like to represent western Waldo County as a delegate to the special Maine Democratic Party State Convention. I have lived in the Liberty area since 1989 and have served as a first responder since 1994—as firefighter, officer and chief, EMT, and Emergency Management Director. As a town official, I have attended Select Board meetings for more than two decades and understand the demands placed on small towns. I served seven years on the town Budget Committee, chairing it for four, and now chair a committee working to repurpose our shuttered elementary school into a community center. At the county level, I support the Midcoast Regional Re-entry Center, serve on the Opioid Settlement Fund Committee, and sit on the Communications Center Advisory Board. These roles have built strong working relationships with the Sheriff's Office, Emergency Management Agency, Communications Center, and Commissioners. In 2024, I ran for Waldo County Commissioner in District 3, knocking on nearly 3,000 doors from Palermo to Burnham. Though I narrowly lost in a solidly Republican district, that campaign deepened my understanding of local concerns and strengthened my commitment to practical, community-focused Democratic leadership. I believe I am known for serving with integrity, compassion, focus, and fairness. As a delegate, I would represent the interests of western Waldo County working people and evaluate candidates based on their credentials, electability, and ability to build support beyond our party. My deep connections across western Waldo County help me find common ground while standing firmly for Democratic values. My

Brown, Robert E II

NORTHPORT

An unprecedented number of Mainers heeded the call for a new movement built on a bold, populist message that speaks to the needs of hardworking Mainers – healthcare for all, an affordable place to live, living wage jobs and the right to join a union, affordable childcare and high quality education, making corporations and the rich pay their fair share of taxes, and protection of civil and human rights for all. To accomplish any of that, we need to take down the corrupt campaign finance system and take back power from the rich and the giant corporations and the politicians they've bought and paid for, like Susan Collins. Collins is a career politician who has used her decades in DC to amass ever greater wealth and power for herself while rigging the system for her campaign donors and her lobbyist husband. I am a lifelong Mainer who grew up in northern Maine in a family of millworkers and farmers, and spent my adult life in the midcoast. I was very involved in Waldo County Democrats in the past, but less so recently as I've focused on raising my son, and on my career helping workers form worker cooperatives to buyout the businesses where they work. I am committed to fairly evaluating all candidates and supporting and working hard for the one who best represents this movement, who can speak clearly and persuasively to both the anger and the hopes of Mainers, and who can hit the ground running to defeat

Burstein, Christine S

LINCOLNVILLE

I have been active in Maine politics for years. As the former State Representative for District 96, I helped flip a longtime Republican seat to a Democratic one — a seat later held by Paige Zeigler and now represented by Mike Ray. During my time in the Legislature, I served on the Health and Human Services Committee, working on issues that matter to Maine families. I got tired of hearing people complain about politics without doing anything about it — so I decided to walk my talk. That's why I ran, and it's why I'm still doing this work today. Beyond the State House, I ran a satellite district office for Waldo County Democrats, served on the Board of the Maine Women's Lobby, and represented Lincolnville on the high school board. I'm also a Nurse Practitioner, a mother, and a wife. On the campaign trail, I knocked on over 5,100 doors, put up and took down signs, entered data for the Democratic Party, and made countless phone calls. I want to serve as a delegate because I know firsthand the work it takes to win — and Collins has to go. I plan to recruit volunteers, train door-knockers, and help coordinate get-out-the-vote efforts across the state, using what I learned flipping my own district. I'm committed to keeping our grassroots energy alive well beyond November — strengthening local Democratic infrastructure, mentoring new organizers, and continuing my work helping expats register and vote. I'd be honored to earn your vote as

Cardamone, Craig Alan

WINTERPORT

I am a 36-year-old progressive Democrat from Winterport. I have been involved in political organizing since Bernie Sanders' first presidential run in 2016. I have served on the Maine Democrat State Committee and consistently support local candidates. My 13 years of experience as a mental health therapist have shaped my belief in the need for progressive policies such as Medicare for All, a Green New Deal, increasing union density, and taxing billionaires. I was involved in Graham's Senate campaign, where I contributed significantly through canvassing, text banking, and volunteering at numerous town halls. I also helped establish a local organizing network in Winterport for Graham and local Democratic candidates. To defeat Susan Collins, we must elect a candidate who not only shares Graham's policy stances but also has a proven track record of upholding them. Graham's campaign demonstrated a strong desire for genuinely progressive policies in Maine and a clear rejection of moderate Democratic approaches. As a delegate, I will evaluate candidates based on their alignment with Graham's policies and their willingness to fight for the interests of working-class Mainers. Candidates must support Graham's platform as well as demonstrate a consistent and unwavering commitment to progressive principles. I am dedicated to transforming the Democratic Party into one that represents working people, not the billionaire class. To achieve this, I will continue to expand my community network and advocate for Democrats who champion progressive causes. Building a grassroots movement is how we will defeat Susan Collins.

Chase, Gail Marie

UNITY

I seek to be a Delegate to the Nominating Convention to support a nominee who has the platform and the experience to defeat Susan Collins, as well as the temperament to succeed in the United States Senate once she is defeated. If elected to be a Delegate, I will listen closely to the candidates to evaluate their positions regarding: support of the needs of all Mainers, including the size and makeup of the families and their wages and working conditions. I want to know their position on who has the right to go to war in the name of American people, how they will address tax fairness and the impossible costs of healthcare. My own experience in supporting candidates includes having been a campaign manager, a driver for candidates, and a canvasser, a signature gatherer and a collector of \$5 donations for Clean Election candidates. I serve as Treasure of the Waldo County Democratic Committee and held the position as Maine's first female State Auditor. Prior to that position, I was the Shop Steward for the Department of Audit. I will support whichever candidate is elected at the Convention, and will work to ensure that candidate's success.

Coffin, Meredith G

FREEDOM

I am a 6th generation Mainer and have lived in Freedom over 40 years. This year of demonstration and resistance has made me grow in new ways. I believe everyone needs to do something. I went out of my comfort zone and began knocking on doors. I talk to everyone I meet. I listen, I share, I read, I ask and I talk more. I will continue this. I found myself working hard for local candidates and am now with a district candidate. As a delegate I will listen hard and carefully to the senatorial candidates. We need sturdy leadership in these times. This is no small feat. I feel the next Maine Democratic Senatorial Candidate needs to have strength, energy and knowledge which is guided by the courage of his or her convictions.

Cohen, Morgan

BELFAST

Born and raised in Maine, I moved away for almost 25 years before choosing to come home. Like Dr. Shah, I choose to fight for Maine. As a Mainer, I am so proud of our state and what we accomplish together here. As a woman, a full-time working professional, and a mother, I support a candidate who will go beyond the boundaries of our state and is willing to give everything they have to confront the members of this dangerous administration and those who are enabling it. I am running to be a delegate to ensure we nominate a candidate that can actually win the general election in November and defeat Susan Collins once and for all. I am excited for the opportunity to participate in this democratic process and will take my responsibility as a voting delegate seriously.

Conard, Gianne P

BELFAST

Beating Susan Collins is the goal that should guide every choice we make now. I had apprehensions about Graham Platner's suitability as a senatorial candidate, but I was always impressed with his ability to stir excitement and connect with Maine residents on issues both foreign and domestic. With Platner no longer in the race, our task is clear: we must find the strongest candidate to beat Susan Collins. The Mainers I encounter every day are hardworking, reflective, and informed. Our new candidate must address their concerns. From my role on Belfast's Planning Board, I know that concerns about affordable housing are real; from Waldo County Bount, I know that food insecurity is real. Through Waterfall Arts I know that parents are struggling to afford meaningful educational experiences for their children. Waterfronts and forest lands face economic pressures and the growing threat of climate change. Women's reproductive rights are being decimated (thank you senator Collins!). Universal healthcare is still out of reach and money continues to destroy our democratic political system. The national Democratic Party and outside 'advisors' did us no favors. Mainers can and must find our own candidate. I want to hear from the candidates themselves, talk with fellow delegates, and work together to find the best person to represent Maine and Mainers in the US Senate. I want us to unite behind the candidate who can beat Susan Collins and I will fully and actively support whomever this process chooses.

Conard, Susan G

NORTHPORT

It is critical that November's election gives us a Democratic majority in the Senate. We must defeat Susan Collins. We must choose a well-vetted, progressive candidate to run against her, a candidate who has demonstrated support for the people of Maine. A candidate who supports equality, rights of minorities and women, and the role of government in ensuring the health and well-being of our people. America is the richest country on earth, yet has the highest poverty levels among developed countries, and the richest billionaires. With an equitable tax system, we can have affordable housing, food security, universal health care, quality education, and financial security as we age. We must spend our tax dollars to improve the lives of our people and to support our allies, not to engage in senseless wars. The US has some of the best scientists in the world. We must support scientific research and ensure that federal policies are based on good science. Our government must recognize the dangers that climate change poses to our lives and our natural environment. We must rapidly accelerate the transition to green energy and away from fossil fuels to tame our rapidly warming climate and to decrease the costs of energy. I retired in 2008 after 25 years in the federal government and moved to Northport, where I have been active in the Democratic party—serving on the state platform committee, phone banking, canvassing, organizing GOTV postcard campaigns in Waldo County. That's where you'll find me until the election.

Cook, Madison Crissey

BELFAST

I'm asking for your support to serve as a delegate because I believe our Waldo County delegation should reflect the energy and values of Maine Democrats. I am committed to the economic, social, and environmental justice that the people of Maine overwhelmingly voted in support of on June 9th. As a delegate, I would support a U.S. Senate nominee who respects the will of Maine Democrats and is prepared to fight for working people, protect our democracy, and defeat Susan Collins. I'm a 29-year-old candidate for the Maine House of Representatives, currently running a grassroots campaign in Belfast, Belmont, and Northport. Every week I'm knocking on doors, talking with voters, recruiting volunteers, and making the case for Democratic values. Those conversations have given me a firsthand understanding of what Mainers are worried about and what they want in their political leadership. My work as a candidate has also given me a unique opportunity to hear directly from voters, giving me the perspective needed to represent the voices of Waldo County in this unprecedented caucus. I would be honored to represent Waldo County as a delegate and would take that responsibility seriously. Thank you for your support.

Youth

Cooper, Marcia

BELFAST

The goal is to replace Susan Collins with a candidate who can represent the people of Maine in order to inspire and insure that a future for All people will be possible. I have been a life long political activist who had spent a career as an advocate for persons with disabilities. Our future as a nation, for our communities, our families and ourselves must build a government which can establish a foundation of strength, empathy and values that energized voters.

Cuddy, Scott William

WINTERPORT

My name is Scott Cuddy, I live in Winterport and I am running to be a delegate to support Troy Jackson to be the Democratic nominee for U.S. Senate. Troy Jackson embodies the change that people in Maine want: a change for the working class, brought about by the working class. His background as a logger, a legislator, and a father give him the experience to know what needs to change and how to accomplish that change. Troy's motto of, "Not from the left, not from the right, I'm from the bottom" is exactly what we need from our politics right now. We need a movement that wells up from the bottom to take the life we want from those who hold us down right now. It is time, and Troy is the right person for the job.

Davis, Jenny

BELFAST

I live in Belfast where I am raising two kids. I practice locally as a primary care provider and a sexual assault forensic nurse. I want to help select a candidate with integrity, who can defeat Susan Collins on a platform that upholds the health and dignity of all Mainers.

LGBTQIA+

Dean, Cynthia

LIBERTY

Susan Collins has done little to stem the erosion of our democracy under the Trump administration. Maine has always stood up for its citizens. While I had reservations about Mr. Platner from the beginning, I felt his energy and agenda would defeat Collins. With his exit from the race, it is crucial our party choose the candidate who can carry on that energy and agenda. I hope to be a part of choosing and supporting that person.

Dolan, Phoebe

BELFAST

I will work tirelessly as a leader of a youth voter engagement non profit to get young Mainers out of for in CD2 - I am also planning to volunteer my time

Youth

Dolloff, Sarah

MONROE

I feel I can be a voice for the 20-30 range mainers who often don't speak up or vote but talk deeply of the challenges facing our demographic. I have lived in a rural farming community and seen how our people have struggled with losing their farms, access to healthcare and the rising cost of living. As a healthcare worker I'm on the front lines of seeing our deteriorating healthcare system and what needs to be done. I have seen families with no insurance struggle to afford basic medical care. I myself have struggled with income insecurity and the ever looming cost of housing thats out of grasp for people my age. And I want to help be a voice to change these issues in the state that raised me

LGBTQIA+, Youth

Donovan, Colin

WALDO

My name is Colin Donovan, I'm 28 years old and I'm running for delegate to the convention. My late mother, Jeanne McIntyre, was a member and volunteer of the Waldo County Democrats for many years prior to her passing in 2025. She raised me as a progressive Democrat who believed in the humanity and dignity of all people, that our greatest strength is our diversity and that our duty as human beings is to protect and love our fellow man and to lend a helping hand when needed. I was a supporter of Graham Platner in the primary, for the same reasons I believe many of us were: because he promoted a vision of Maine that works for working-class Mainers, and because Susan Collins not only enables Trump's attacks on democracy, but is complicit in his administration's worst excesses, including the brutalization and murder of innocent people by ICE, the repeal of Roe v. Wade, and the Netanyahu regime's genocide of Palestinians. We must defeat her and end this madness. Platner is now rightfully removed from this process, as anyone credibly accused of rape has no business running for Senate - even if someone convicted of it is President. But his progressive platform was supported overwhelmingly by the people of Maine, and the Maine Democratic Party has the responsibility to select a replacement that represents Maine voters. If elected as delegate, I pledge to support a progressive candidate who will defeat Collins and stand up to Trump and Netanyahu.

LGBTQIA+, Youth

Drozd, Anya

SEARSMONT

I think we had all hoped that we had found a candidate that different from the normal DNC candidates, that was committed to the same ideals we had of free Medicare for all, keeping billionaires out of our business, supporting the working class and putting our tax money into our communities. I think we have a wonderful momentum to find this new candidate that reflects those same ideals, and I am very excited to be a part of that search. I think we need to maintain energy and commitment to the change we want to see.

Dunckel, Kathleen

BELFAST

I would like to be a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I believe I understand what is at stake in this election cycle and what the people of Maine are ready to vote for and it is not the status quo. Platner's frustration and anger about the realities of his lived experience resonated with so many of us. It created a movement that I haven't felt the energy of since Bernie Sanders was running for the presidency and we must keep that energy alive. The people of Maine are ready for change that will directly improve their lives. This is a moment not to be squandered. We must carry the progressive platform underpinning Platner's success forward with the candidate that has the same fire and will for change. The next nominee must be passionate and able to articulate to the people of Maine how they

will help to curb executive overreach and reestablish the role of a Senator as a civic servant to the people and as guardians of our constitution. I will work with the Maine DNC to defeat Susan Collins by helping to coordinate with groups around the state that share similar goals and values such as Maine All Care, Maine ACLU, Indivisible, Equality Maine, and student led organizations on our college campus' that are working to combat climate change and social and political injustice. This will fuel our grassroots movement and build on the fire that Platner ignited.

Dwyer, Eve Karen

SWANVILLE

I am resident of Swanville Maine. I am a retired person. My income is static. It is Social Security. I have lived in the state of Maine 61 years. As an American citizen as a citizen of Swanville as a person who completely believes in individuality and community, I feel it is my duty to request to be considered as a delegate to this convention. There is no time in my mind that I can look back to and see a less secure democracy. If I don't step up and speak for those who feel that democracy is in danger that are voting rights are being attacked that we are having less and less say about what the government does and how the government expresses the United States to the international community. Then I have nothing to say or no reason to complain about what the current Administration is doing has done and I'm afraid is going to do going forward. So I put my hat in the ring and I ask if not me who I feel compelled to step forward to voice the concerns of the people in my circle in my community in my county in my state and yes, even in this country, we must stand together. We must not be silent. We must hold, dear the ideals that Gray and Plattin had put forward that our Democratic platform will be and that the people of this state deserve. If nominated to the convention, I will

Disability

Eads, Mary S

SEARSPORT

Hello, Thank you for attending today and the gift of your time for the very important task of electing qualified candidates who will nominate the best candidate to WIN the Maine Senate seat currently held by Susan Collins. It's way past time; we elect someone who will represent all Mainers and improve our day-to-day lives. Our newly elected Maine Senator must fight for healthcare for all, give women reproductive healthcare, equality for all, protect and improve Medicare/Mainecare, and Social Security, improve public education/schools, uphold tribal sovereignty and self-determination, and improve support for our veterans. Yes, it's not going to be easy, but I believe we can do it! I was born in a large democratic family, and politics had an important role in keeping us united even when we didn't always agree. I volunteer for the Waldo County Dems by working in the office talking with people and canvassing for local, state, and federal candidates encouraging people to vote. I will continue to do this work and more from now through the November election regardless of my nomination status. I was a delegate who attended the state convention and served on the state credentialing committee. Let's all join arms and show the country what Mainers can do and say "NO" to the Chaos, Corruption,

and Cruelty of this administration that Susan Collins owns! Abolish Ice!!! Save our democracy!!!
Respectfully submitted, Mary Eads

Ellis, Stephen

WALDO

I was a candidate for the Maine House, earning 45% of the vote in conservative District 38. I have effectively engaged with Senators King & Collins and Rep. Golden as a member of Citizens Climate Lobby; and with the Maine Legislature for a variety of progressive issues. I enthusiastically supported Graham and his platform. I wish to serve as delegate essentially “pledged” to Shenna Bellows, meaning I will vote for Shenna in every round unless she’s eliminated, in which case I will vote for my top choice of remaining candidates. I believe Shenna is the best candidate now. I’ve seen her in action - she has exceptional leadership skills as evidenced by her management of organizations, people and process (I observed this directly as a participant in the 2024 CD2 recount). Shenna motivates and respects every person on her team and they respond with dedication and commitment. To be effective, Senators need strong teams in DC and around the state to serve constituents. As senator Shenna will assemble very strong teams committed to our values, platform, priorities and public service. Success in DC also depends on building relationships with lawmakers and legislative directors. With her outgoing personality, collaborative approach and national connections Shenna will be well-received in the Senate and will earn meaningful committee assignments. Most importantly, Shenna’s wide appeal to Mainers places her in the strongest position to defeat Susan Collins. Please elect me as delegate so that I can help elect Senator Bellows. Thank you.

Elwell, Caleb Edward

BELFAST

Whether this Republic will have a Senate that continues to enable Donald Trump, or one that instead works to oppose him could very well come down to this State, and the choice that 601 of our fellow Mainers make in two weeks. I would be honored to serve as a delegate in this process. I grew up in central Maine, in a small town called Hartland on the border of Somerset county. I returned to Maine after receiving my law degree, and now work as an attorney in environmental law. In my role I witness—and play my small role in resisting—the damage that this administration does. As a delegate, my first principle for consideration will be the likelihood that a given candidate will be able to both defeat Susan Collins in November, and effectively resist this lawless administration after that. I also strongly believe that, while he turned out to be deeply flawed as an individual, the campaign and movement that Graham Platner built should continue. Mr. Platner clearly recognized and spoke to a pervasive desire for change held by many citizens of this State. He was also willing to plainly name the obstacles to that change—systemic wealth inequality and entrenched economic interests. I believe that any nominee should embody these ideals. If nominated as a delegate, I would look to support a candidate who meets these criteria and, to the best of my ability, attempt to honor the great trust that such a nomination would represent.

Facey, Geoffrey

BELFAST

I want to help ensure that the chosen candidate is able to care the energy and momentum that has already been built, and represents the policies and politics that the historic number of voters in our primary voted for

French, Gerry M Jr

SEARSPORT

I firmly believe that our democracy is at stake. We need to flip that Senate seat and do it now! Not during the next cycle, but immediately! I pledge to put forth a vote that will give us the best opportunity to do just that! Thank you for your consideration.

Fulford, Jonathan Steven

BELFAST

I will vote for a candidate who can win against Susan Collins. I will vote for a candidate who shares the progressive policy goals and vision that the people who voted for Graham Platner saw in his campaign. I will vote for a candidate with longstanding progressive and populist credentials reflected in a history of effective and courageous leadership. I will vote for a candidate who will use the power of their office to call out injustice, inequity and fascism boldly and to follow through using their position to create meaningful change. I will vote for a candidate who has been raised in CD2 in a rural working class family and has never forgotten that they serve all the people of Maine, not just the wealthy and powerful. I will vote for a candidate who has shown that they will work hard. (in 2016 Shenna successfully ran for state senate, in that race she broke the record for the most doors knocked in one campaign with 12,200 doors!) I think there are only two viable progressive candidates in the race, Shenna Bellows and Troy Jackson. Shenna meets all of the criteria above, is the best qualified and I think most likely to win against Collins in November. I will listen to the speeches at convention and make a final decision then, but at this point I think we need a strong experienced progressive woman leader as our next senator from Maine.

Gardner, Patricia A

NORTHPORT

I wish to help select a candidate who brings the same issues Graham Platner brought to the campaign. We need someone fresh and not from the political establishment.

Geffken, Chloe

LINCOLNVILLE

I would like to be a delegate firstly because of my belief that political participation at local levels is essential in the pursuit of democratic ideals. I was 3 years old when Susan Collins was first voted in, and I am desperate to see her unseated. I want to see a candidate for senate who has empathy and understanding for all Mainers, which I think is the only way to win the seat. I will support loudly and wholeheartedly a candidate who demonstrates that broad appeal but still remains firm in their convictions. I also will not get caught up in any cult of personality type support of someone, which has shown to be a dangerous political game over the past decade. The strength of a grassroots movement is in its ability to embrace and uplift perspectives outside of what is expected from a political entity. I will listen, I will seek to understand, I will respect the viewpoints and opinions of my county. To me, supporting a grassroots movement means embracing the changing tide with openheartedness. My desire to participate in the convention process stems from my desire to see this changing world become one that I want to live in.

LGBTQIA+, Disability, Youth

Gibson, Alan C

BELFAST

I'm the owner of GO Logic, a design-build company headquartered in Belfast. We're a company of 42 people, designing and building climate-responsible homes in a time when housing and the climate are both in crisis. I've been involved in discussions at the state level, at regional conferences, and at symposiums held at our Belfast shop about increasing housing production while meeting the state's ambitious climate goals (both can be done). I'm also active in the democratic party, having canvassed in the fall of 2024 for the Biden-Harris campaign. I've supported Hannah Pingree at the maximum donation level and co-hosted an event for her a few weeks ago. The race for US Senate in Maine is incredibly important. Susan Collins is very powerful but also quite vulnerable. We need a candidate who can speak to the obvious facts: she's a staunch supporter of Donald Trump and his disastrous policies, voted for legislation that further concentrates wealth in the hands of fewer and fewer people, takes away health care and food assistance at a time when vulnerability is high, and voted to approve the most radical transformation of our judicial system in generations. I will support whichever candidate can articulate most clearly and forcefully the reasons Collins must go, can connect with voters and defeat her in November. I have a broad network throughout the state, many of whom supported Platner, and I'll work hard to convince them to back the nominee.

Goldstein, Joshua

BELFAST

I have been a very active member of the Belfast Democratic Party. I have served on the Diversity Equity Inclusion committee led by Laura Baker for the last three years. And was on the statewide committee for two years. In Boston where I lived for many years, I was on the steering committee and worked hard to elect Barack Obama President. I have canvassed for Maine Dem candidates since my move to Belfast. I supported Graham Platner until recently and am angry that he was not carefully vetted before he became the nominee. That is more our fault than his. We need to be much more careful in the future and put in place a vetting process which is much more robust. I look forward to playing a very active role in the process of finding his replacement. Platner has a devoted constituency and we must do everything we can not to alienate his supporters.

Disability, Underrepresented Religion

Gordon, Jaclyn MARIE

SWANVILLE

I would like to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Committee for several reasons. 1) I am invested in the welfare of all Mainers. I am from Maine and love our small town communities. I love how we help each other out through the hard winter seasons, celebrate together through our festivals, endure tourist season with good humor and how we come together to support community members in need. 2) I vote regularly, pay attention to the needs of our communities and stay up-to-date on Maine politics. I volunteered to canvas for Kamala Harris in Waldo County. I knocked on all kinds of doors and spoke with people who were in agreement and engaged politely in discourse with those who weren't. 3) Most of all, I want to make sure that the voice of the people is heard and followed. We overwhelmingly voted for a candidate who has very progressive ideas and goals. The next candidate we should be of like mind with goals that are aligned with the previous candidate. Maine has asked for change and my generation, wants to see that through.

Grant, Richard

LINCOLNVILLE

I'm a gay U.S. Coast Guard veteran, grandfather, author, and Waldo County resident since 1990. I was a Clinton delegate in 2016 — but how the world has changed since then! Time is short, I believe, to save our democracy. We need to fire ourselves up. We need to go out there with confidence and conviction to reclaim our Party's place as the champion of everyday people: workers, makers, teachers, artists, builders, moms and dads. People who work on the water. Who work in offices. Who prepare and serve food. Who care for our most vulnerable citizens. All of whom are being squeezed and ruthlessly exploited in our present GOP-led dystopia. We've got a winning message. What we need are bold and articulate messengers. Graham Platner, flawed though he may be, found a way to speak our truths that a wide swath of everyday people could connect with. No defensive crouch. No

tiptoeing. No Republican Lite. This is who we are; this is how we'll restore justice to America; these are the ways in which everyday people will benefit. What I plan to do personally between now and election day are things I've gotten pretty good at: writing and phone banking. And as I've done for years, wearing a rainbow donkey lapel pin everywhere I go, and talking politics with anyone, anywhere.

LGBTQIA+, Underrepresented Religion

Gruchow, Emilie

BELFAST

I would like to serve for two reasons. First, I believe that the process for choosing a new nominee reflects a truly grassroots effort. Second, it is incredibly important that people who voted for Graham in June- both registered Democrats and unenrolled- can see this process as legitimate and driven from the ground up. The organizing done over the past year worked. We should be proud of that, and use the power that we built, even if the circumstances aren't what we hoped. For the past two weeks, local Democrat volunteers and voters from across the state have successfully pushed for a solution that respects the popular vote on June 9th while protecting the nomination from invalidating legal challenges. The people who crafted this plan volunteered and canvassed alongside us, and have earned trust. At the same time, everyone who voted on June 9th has a right to demand that their delegates reflect their voices. If selected, I would vote in every round at the convention in a way that prioritizes the platform that voters chose on June 9th. That said, I will also remain open and available to all voters, and to policy and social concerns that fell outside that platform. The candidates who reflect those additional issues best will influence my decision. Selected or not, I will continue canvassing and advocating for full voter participation in the November election, stressing that this is not the end of the work of the past year, but a continuation of it.

Gulezian, Greta Zorn

LINCOLNVILLE

Having witnessed friends and townsfolk in my community of Lincolnville, some of whom have not paid attention to Maine politics in the past, become interested in and encouraged by the progressive policies discussed in the campaign leading to the June 9 primary, I am motivated to support this movement by serving as a delegate. I will use my energy and voice to support the most electable candidate who can defeat Susan Collins in November. Maine's Democratic nominee for U.S. Senate has the opportunity and responsibility to maximize the momentum created by grassroots volunteers who created this movement for a different kind of politics. More than 70% of voters on June 9, in a record turnout, unmistakably voted for a progressive agenda. Democrats and unenrolled Maine residents worked engaging Mainers with the issues Mainers care about: human and civil rights for all, stopping the unauthorized wars, authoritarianism, attacks on our voting rights, ICE/CBP violence against immigrants and residents of our State, declining access to health care, lack of affordable housing, US complicity in war crimes and atrocities. Knocking on doors, perhaps coordinating a public town hall, helping distribute yard signs, reaching out to unenrolled voters, speaking with people in the Lincolnville/Belfast area to get out the vote for our Senate nominee are ways I can help continue to

build grassroots momentum for a progressive nominee. We The People have the power. Now is the time. Thank you for your consideration.

Hargrove, Jesse William

THORNDIKE

I have lived in Thorndike since 1986, graduated from Mt. View High School and the University of Maine. I have raised my kids in the same community, served on the Thorndike Planning Board, RSU 3 School Board, and Waldo County Technical Center, for over a decade. I have been a public school teacher since 2002. I'm currently serving as President of the Maine Education Association, the professional association and union representing about 24,000 active and retired public education employees prek-12, university of Maine and Community College systems. I have phone banked for Waldo Co Dems and served as a chair for Thorndike caucus.

Hart, Patrick

LINCOLNVILLE

I am a believer in the movement started by Mr Platner. I intend to be active in any way I am called upon to promote the Democratic candidate for US Senate against Ms Collins. My preference is for a progressive, charismatic and experienced candidate who will effectively represent the working people of Waldo County and Maine. Particularily interested in Affordable and available health care for all, income and tax support for middle class, housing, big money in elections and corruption. Having said that, I am most drawn to a candidate with character and backbone, Everything else will follow. Open to hearing from any candidate that expresses interest. Thank you.

Hausman-Smith, Barbara

BELFAST

Maine voters are independent from the rest of the country. I am committed to vote for what Mainers need and deserve despite national media's misrepresentation of those qualities. Let's worry about registering and getting out the vote at the grassroots level rather than fancy algorithms and big money. I want a candidate who will throw themselves into the race and not listen to national campaign operatives who think they know Maine without any interest in talking to us. Maine voters respond to hard work and the promise of a decent life. I'm committed to the candidate who hears them. Let's transform the election so that we talk about real issues. Let's remind the voters that it is Collins who has deprived us of decent lives and a fair deal. It's possible if we boil it all down to what is good for Maine.

Hebert, Alan John

BELFAST

Since retiring in 2022, I have been an active member and volunteer in the Waldo County Democratic Committee. I am a lifelong registered Democrat and I am committed to electing Democrats to office, both nationally and in state. In the past, I have knocked on doors, driven candidates in their canvassing efforts, volunteered for helping out with fundraising projects, mailing and phone campaigns, as well as being a delegate in two previous elections. I intend to continue these efforts and more, in supporting whichever candidate is chosen as a replacement. Graham Platner created a lot of enthusiasm in the run-up to the primary, and I'd like to have a part in electing a candidate who can continue to carry this enthusiasm into the election and give Susan Collins and the Republicans the defeat they have deserved for a long time coming.

Henstrand, Ann

SEARSMONT

I would be honored beyond measure to serve as a Nominating Convention delegate. I have been part of the grassroots movement in Waldo County serving on the leadership team of Indivisible Waldo County for the past 16 months, helping to organize No Kings protests, Signs of Fascism standouts, and more. I have always deeply cared about democracy - in Oak Park IL before our final move to Maine in 2022, I was a pledged 2020 delegate for Senator Amy Klobuchar, gaining a glimpse at Iowa caucusing norms. My first campaign work was stuffing envelopes for Senator McGovern in 8th grade. I remember describing how voting works as a tour guide in the early 1980s to Chinese tour partners late at night in hushed tones over candlelight - even something as simple as what a ballot box looks like was foreign and felt illicit. Our prime responsibility now is to persevere, to communicate, to community-build, to preserve democracy. Nothing is more important than free and fair elections. This is our moment and absolute rectitude in fair process is critical. Susan Collins and her ilk must be defeated. Nothing is more important than ensuring that this nominating process and our elections are fair, transparent, and open. I will not sleep and I pledge to do all I can to uphold transparency and stoke rather than still our community's heart and further our State's commitment to preserving democracy.

Hikida, Matsu

MONTVILLE

My name is Matsu Hikida, I'm a queer and trans farmer in Waldo County. I have been involved in statewide politics and policy since moving to Maine in 2018, working mainly with environmental organizations and voting rights groups. Lately, my disillusionment with the political establishment's false promises has led me to focus my efforts on mutual aid and community organizing. I believe that all Mainers deserve affordable food and housing, dignity in the workplace, clean air and water, and free healthcare. I also believe that Susan Collins would prefer to take money from corporations and billionaires than fulfill these basic needs for her constituents, although I haven't confirmed this since

her last town hall was before I was born. Having cut my teeth on a citizen's initiative (11/2018's Question 1), I know that Maine politics and grassroots organizing go hand-in-hand. I also know that my perspective as a young person, a person of color, a member of the LGBTQ+ community, a seasonal farmworker, and a small business owner will allow me to connect with a wide range of Mainers in the true spirit of the grassroots movement. And with the right candidate, someone who is not only willing to tap into this energy but is already doing so, I know that Susan Collins can finally be defeated.

BIPOC, LGBTQIA+, Disability, Underrepresented Religion, Youth

Hoffman, Jana Marie

WINTERPORT

I wish to uphold the voice of the people of Maine who voted for the values and policy platform of the previous candidate. I believe Troy Jackson is our very best option to achieve that goal. These proceedings are very atypical, and it is urgently important that we insure that this process is transparent and democratic and reflects the will of the voters of Maine as expressed in the primary. I am a mother who is disabled and queer, and believe it is important to have many voices represent the people of our county in these proceedings. I value human dignity, affordable housing, healthcare for everyone, and safety and freedom for all humans, regardless of their origins or identities.

LGBTQIA+, Disability

Hoffman, Tyson

WINTERPORT

"By the People, and for the People" Right now, government has been captured and molded by oligarchs. Costs go up at vets, dentists, grocery stores, and gas stations. But the workers don't benefit, and the oligarchs get richer, and more able to influence government to their benefit. SNAP benefits are restricted, community cupboards are strained, our son was one of the last born at Waldo County Hospital. Its time for a Senator that represents the people to be elected. Someone who will get us universal healthcare, like so many countries have. Someone who will end wars for profit and subjugation. Someone who won't accept money from Super PACs or AIPAC. Someone who will stop letting Trump and the republicans destroy our social safety nets. Someone who will remove investors from buying housing. Someone who protects minorities: LGBTQ+, PoC, Native Americans, and Immigrants. Someone who will tax the rich, who only earn that money because we work for them. I will support a candidate that espouses all these Progressive causes, and more. I believe Troy Jackson, Paige Loud, and Shenna Bellows will all do so, and I will support them in that order, and maybe others if they support progressive causes and look like they can remove Susan Collins from office. I live in Winterport with a wife and three kids, who I want to live in a world that supports them.

Holtshouser, Sherrell

STOCKTON SPRINGS

I am will and able to serve as a delegate from Waldo. My home is in Stockton Springs. I am a member of the Maine Democratic Party. I previously lived in Alaska and served as a delegate to the Alaska Democratic Party State Convention. Susan Collins is a servant to those who are destroying our democracy and they, and she, must be defeated. I want to help make that happen.

Inglennook, Ash

BELFAST

I was so hopeful to watch Maine build a grassroots movement based on dismantling the corporate elite in the US. If I am chosen as a Waldo County delegate I would vote for the democratic nominee that will hold those values and represent myself and my neighbors. I believe it is time to represent ourselves. I am a wife and mom, and I love my community and my home enough to volunteer for this position in hopes of defending and protecting our ideals and our democracy.

Immigrant/New Mainer, Disability

Italiaander, David

SEARSPORT

It is vital that a delegate recognizes the need for a candidate to be able to carry the message and values of The Movement forward and that has the communication skills and abilities to effectively share them with the voters and the press. Most importantly they must have the grit and stamina to work tirelessly to cover every inch of the State in search of votes (and to make a news when possible) between now and November. I will do everything in my power to defeat Susan Collins including canvassing and GOTV. In the last state/national election I knocked on over 450 doots in Waldo and Hancock counties. I will redouble my efforts to defeat Suzie!

Jack, Cameron

BELFAST

I feel like i represent hard working Mainers who want a fair and clean process for our government and I support union workers/individuals who want agency in their choice for senate

Youth

Jackson, William

STOCKTON SPRINGS

If Mrs. Collins win, we will lose our American democracy. We cannot let that happen. Troy Jackson is progressive, and I trust that he will fight to undo the damage that Trump has caused.

BIPOC

Jean, Haley

BELFAST

I am 32 and hoping to start a family in Maine. I struggle to see a way forward with my goals if our government continues as it has been. My partner and I would simple not be able to afford it. It is also important to be to have a government and at least representatives that believe in conservative and climate change.

Johnston, Anora

THORNDIKE

I am a working mom, and I have felt many of the ways our current senator has failed us. We need a candidate who will support families, workers, the environment, and healthcare access; including a woman's right to choose. How terrible is it that Maine still has the right to abortion, but our senator took it from so many other Americans? I want our country to stop enabling the murder of children, in our classrooms and around the world. We need a senator who will do all they can to stop Trump's wars, and stop the genocide in Gaza. Susan Collins has been our senator for almost as long as I've been alive, and my life in Maine, especially my life as a parent and an employee, are harder because of Collins choices for Maine. The two closest hospitals close to me have closed because of the medicare cuts, all the paper mills near me have closed at the behest of Collin's billionaire supporters. We need a strong candidate who will call Collins on her hypocrisy, who knows how to fight for Mainers, and has a platform we as Mainers can be proud of supporting. In our primary, we showed the nation that we are ready to support progressive policy, we need someone whos ready to carry that momentum to Washington.

LGBTQIA+, Youth

KIMBERLY, TUCKER

SEARSPORT

This is going to short and sweet. We need to take the lying bitch out of office plain and simple. I had been a union officer for over thirty years -9 of which was President and BM of IBEW 1777, on the AFL-CIO executive board for several terms, member of the Maine AMPS council, worked with Food

and Medicine for many years. Also was Dem chair of the town of Prospect for many years. I AM a true Blue Dog!

Kossuth, Ann Frenning

NORTHPORT

I want to serve as a delegate to this Nominating Convention for the same reason I served as a delegate to the convention in Portland: showing up for the process matters. Waldo County is sending delegates to help choose the person who will take on Susan Collins this November, and I want to be one of the people in that room representing our county. Once the party selects its nominee, my job begins. I will support that candidate, because beating Collins matters more than any one person's outcome. My focus will be talking with neighbors, reaching voters I already know in Waldo County, and doing the real work of getting people to vote. Right now I'm chairing fundraising for a new community center, town office, and fire station in Northport, because people need real places to come together in a polarized world. When the Searsmont fire broke out, over 40 fire departments showed up to help, including Northport's volunteer force on which my husband serves. Nobody on that scene was asking who anyone voted for, and a safer fire station is something that everyone can agree on. I want to bring that same spirit to this work as a delegate. The grassroots energy that built around this race doesn't have to disappear. My job as a delegate is to help carry that energy through the convention and into the general election, and to keep building real relationships with real people between now and November 3rd.

LGBTQIA+, Underrepresented Religion

Laitin, Jon L

THORNDIKE

I have campaigned door to door for Democratic candidates in prior elections and I am well aware of how crucial this senate seat is to the preservation of my country's democracy. I will do everything in my power to elect the Democratic candidate whoever he or she may be and I look forward to being part of nominating process.

Lawn, Paul

SEARSPORT

I am 80 years old. Never in my lifetime has our republic been more endangered. A fascist regime threatens to rig our elections and complete its takeover of our country. My first duty as a citizen is to try my utmost to defeat them and preserve our republic. That duty transcends any to my party, but today my party offers the only realistic hope. We gather to choose a senatorial candidate in a race that may well decide its majority. If we take the Senate we deal Trumpism a blow from which it may never recover. Kudos to Graham Platner for his electric grassroots campaign rousing us to action. While sad about shortcomings of character and organization that doomed his run, we must capture his energy

and transform the ashes of his campaign into the compost that feeds our growing resistance. Notwithstanding the blather of the NYT and other “mainstream” media, Platner is not the only candidate in Maine with progressive ideas, great courage and the charisma to fire up voters, or even better, the platform, experience and nuanced chops to work skillfully towards their fruition in the Senate as we begin the long road of our third great American resurrection. Why choose me as your delegate? I have mostly resided in Maine since 1973, founded Fedco Seeds Co-operative in 1978, worked 40 years and now sit on its Board. I studied constitutional law at Yale Law School. I will listen to the candidates, study their platforms and choose wisely.

LeMay, Gabriel

BELFAST

I am going to support Troy Jackson with the convention, as he is the most competitive candidate to defeat Susan Collins. I am in a union and Tory has been the most supportive nominee in recent memory. I also believe he has the most appeal among independent voters, particularly in rural areas, where I live.

Levine, Betsy

LIBERTY

Our nominee must represent the will of the voters. Assuming Graham Platner won 72% of the votes based upon his platform and his ability to create excitement and involvement, our replacement candidate must have that same vision and ability to talk genuinely about the issues we face. We need meaningful change and a senator who understands the anger and frustration we feel, and who will be able to beat Susan Collins and make a difference in DC. We need a senator who puts Maine first, but also understands the importance of our place in the world at large, and holds our values strong: the need to support one another in a generous and caring manner, to support universal healthcare, protect our environment, reproductive freedom, public education, social and economic justice, and get money and favoritism out of politics and government. Convention delegates should recognize that not everyone votes along party lines and there are many independents who vote on the issues, and yes, some vote on personality. At this point, I feel that Shenna Bellows best exemplifies these traits and values, with Troy Jackson running second. As a delegate, I will keep an open mind, and vote for the candidate who both shares these ideals and can win in the general election.

Littlefield, Matthew

WALDO

i am currently the campaign manager for Alan Orcutt (state house candidate). I believe the right kinds of issues were being focused on by Platner. Specifically, the focus on working class families this party has seemed to have lost. I want to help continue the push to address the concerns that truly matter (affordability, clean energy, medicare for all) and defeat Susan Collins.

Maseychik, Tammy

NORTHPORT

I am applying to be a delegate to support Troy Jackson on July 25th to take Graham Platner's place as our Democratic nominee because I feel his policies are most in line with those we voted for in the Primary. I am a life long Mainer, long time Democrat and a small business owner. I have now and in the past campaigned and financially supported many democrats to flip congress. I have worked my way through school and from below the poverty line to a business owner who employs 5 people and supports working class and middle class workers, healthcare for all and perhaps most importantly, removing Donal Trump and his administration and holding them accountable for their crimes including many counts of abuse of power. Please let me be a leader for our County and continue to promote the progressive policies that can affect REAL change in our country.

Metzler, Michele Gross

LINCOLNVILLE

I am high school social studies teacher with over 25 years of experience who believes that transparency, fairness, and democratic participation are fundamental to a strong and healthy democracy. Every day, I encourage my students to become informed and to be active citizens. Serving as a delegate in the Senate Nomination Process this summer is an opportunity for me to put the same values I teach into practice. I am proud that the Democratic Party has chosen an open and participatory nomination process, and I would be honored to help ensure it is thoughtful, inclusive, and transparent. In addition to teaching, I also have experience serving in leadership roles in my union, including participating in contract negotiations. This has strengthened my skills and commitment to collaborating and building consensus when representing the interests of a group, all of which I would bring to the convention. Participatory democracy is a cornerstone of our government. As a delegate, my priority would be to help ensure that our party conducts the most comprehensive, transparent, and inclusive process possible. After our nominee is selected, I am committed to helping elect a Democratic senator and defeat Susan Collins in November by talking with voters, encouraging civic participation, and supporting local organizing efforts. I would be honored to have the opportunity to contribute thoughtfully, work collaboratively, and help select the best candidate to run in the general election this fall. I look forward to the opportunity to serve. Thank you!

Miller, Trudy F

NORTHPORT

Graham Platner received almost 72% of the Waldo County votes in the June 9 Democratic Senate primary. For those voters it is very important that our next nominee represent to the extent possible the values and policies which the Platner volunteers worked so hard to support. It goes without saying that for us these are the core values of the Democratic Party and we want our next Senator to embrace them fully. As the Platner campaign's Waldo County volunteer leader, and the Advisory

Board member from Waldo County, I am well positioned to both represent those values and to evaluate candidates with respect to their adherence when it comes to voting for our next nominee. For nine months as a staging location director for the Platner campaign I worked with a large number of Platner supporters and volunteers on whom I could call in the future to work to defeat Susan Collins. The enormous grassroots momentum going into the primary election came from the Platner campaign's organization and volunteers. The latter must be encouraged to continue on as a major part of the base on which to build the next Senate campaign if we hope to succeed in defeating Susan Collins.

Mitchell, Jordan

BELFAST

Susan Collins can be beaten. A candidate with the courage to fight the oligarchs, end our involvement in forever wars, champion the rights of women, and make life affordable for working class people is necessary to capture the enthusiasm for change in Maine. As a delegate, I will vote for whomever possesses the greatest will to pursue this platform and best present it to Mainers. My name is Jordan Mitchell, I'm a 32y.o. Nurse from Belfast. I became a first time parent this past year and I'm desperate to see our country begin the path to a more hopeful future for us all; a future that needs to be demanded of those representing us. Our candidate needs to know the struggles of working Mainers, stand against corruption in Washington, and be an unwavering advocate for democracy and decency towards LGBTQ+ and all communities being targeted by this administration. Maine cannot afford to be represented by someone who stands aside as Republicans dismantle so much that we value. We need a candidate that recognizes working hard is no longer enough to ensure a better life, that our justice system and economy are rigged to benefit the wealthy at the expense of the poor, and that our neighbors are needlessly suffering because healthcare is unaffordable. Our road to recovering from the atrocities of the current administration will be a long one, choosing the right nominee and removing Susan Collins is a step that could have us well on our way.

Nittolo, Jennifer Lynn

WINTERPORT

I want to serve as a delegate because this moment needs to be about the movement, not any one person. Graham Platner stepping aside was the right call, but the energy behind this campaign - the "Fighting Oligarchy" crowds, the hunger for a genuine working-class fighter - doesn't have to go anywhere. Troy Jackson has spent decades in the Legislature fighting for loggers, working families, and healthcare access. He built coalitions as Senate President, and he stepped up on almost no notice because beating Susan Collins matters more to him than his own timeline. I want my vote at the Convention to help make him our nominee. To defeat Collins in November, I'll do what I've always done in Maine politics: show up. I'll canvass, phone bank, and use my own platform - I run a small business and I'm active in political and grassroots advocacy circles across the state - to make sure Mainers understand what's at stake in flipping this seat. Grassroots momentum isn't built top-down. It's built by neighbors talking to neighbors, showing up at town halls, and staying engaged after

election day, not just before it. I've been doing that work for years, and I want to keep doing it as a delegate who represents real voters - not just party insiders - in choosing our nominee.

Norris-Jacobs, Jacob

LIBERTY

I'm seeking to serve as a delegate on July 25th to the nominating convention; this election carries a lot of weight and requires boots on the ground action. Not sitting on the sidelines. I'm a strong believer that leadership is built by engaging grass roots activists who are willing to come together and lift the party as one. When we organize, listen, and bring people together; even the heaviest weights can be lifted with ease. Now is the time to ensure our party nominates a candidate who actually represents the working class. A candidate who inspires confidence in the people of Maine and can represent all of us. To help defeat Senator Susan Collins in November, I'm willing to actively volunteer by talking with voters, making phone calls, knocking on doors, and encouraging friends, family, and neighbors to become involved. Civic engagement doesn't stop at the end of a campaign season, it's our civic duty to continue to organize year round and make our voices heard. It is our duty to create opportunities for people to participate, feel heard and most importantly develop future leaders. When we strengthen our democratic party with grassroots efforts we create the momentum that will carry on for future generations.

O'Connell, Coleen Rae

BELFAST

I am part of the revolution to take back America for working class people I was excited for all the energy shown for Platner's campaign and it doesn't have to die. Troy is our guy to get behind.

Olds, Eric Huntington

LINCOLNVILLE

I think Troy Jackson is the best person to replace Platner on the ballot and defeat Susan Collins and I want to help make that happen in any way that I can. Beyond serving as a delegate I would like to help make that happen in any way that I can. I have over 18 years experience in economic and market research and can offer those skills if needed.

Olson, Victoria M

WALDO

Why I want to be a Delegate: I believe we deserve better governance. I want to help us get it. What I Bring to the Party: Energy Enthusiasm Eyes on the Prize Skills and Experience: Sales and Marketing Improvisational Acting Early Childhood Educator (Former) Business Owner Health Care Provider Soft

Power: Active listening Comic timing Desire to engage Playfulness Creativity Respectful confrontation I am bold, bright, and experienced. I will talk to almost anyone. I have curiosity, compassion, warmth and humor, and keen observation. I look and listen. I pay attention. Leading up to mid-term elections in 2026 and beyond, I plan to continue reaching out to neighbors and friends - and also total strangers - to keep the conversation going. I circulate petitions, gather signatures, knock on doors, find allies, and do the work. We need civic discourse. We need the best questions to stimulate our hearts and minds. We need a clear vision for our future as a community, a society, a country, a world. What should a government do for its citizens? What do we owe to one another in a civil society? What is the role of a citizen? How do we find our way to trust and to a shared reality? To anyone reading this, thank you for what you do. I look forward to working with you in any capacity to better our situation and be the best of ourselves. See you on down the road.

Page, Pamela

PALERMO

Here is a little bit about me. I worked in Maine as a veterinarian for 23 years until a motor vehicle accident ended that career. I live on a small farm in Palermo and am an ardent environmentalist. Since my accident, I have immersed myself in community work. I am an active member of several town committees, boards and organizations, and am involved in multiple environmental and wildlife projects. I have also volunteered for the Maine Democratic Party over the years, especially in recent years. I am running to be a delegate because I want to be able to vote, and I wish that every Maine Democrat could vote in this forum. I am a supporter of Graham Platner's populist platform, will vote for a progressive candidate, and will advocate for, encourage and wholeheartedly support the grassroots momentum that has surged from the Graham Platner phenomenon. As a delegate, I will vigorously help to defeat Susan Collins in November and believe the best way to do that is to listen to and include the grassroots supporters from the Platner campaign. Their energy, fire passion and ideals are essential for our success this November.

Palm, Alison R

BELFAST

I am the biracial daughter of a naturalized citizen, and an emergency room nurse. All of these things mean that I daily see the consequences of racism, misogyny, and systemic power imbalances. As an emergency nurse, I use the power I have within the system to create more humane, respectful experiences for patients, but I am also well aware that no amount of personal humanity can change the deadly outcomes of insurance companies making decisions that favor investments over people's lives, or of lawmakers deciding that women dying is acceptable. As a woman of color, I am well aware that the systems that currently decide many fates put my own life and happiness in danger. I am also a community member, and someone who believes in the possibility of collective change. I believe that the things I already do - protest publicly, create community spaces for deep conversation and vulnerability, and invite real conversation about real issues with everyone I interact with - are important. I also believe that choosing strong, compassionate, public servants to create systems that

are safer, healthier, and more joyful is incredibly important. I would love to use my perspective to help us choose the best possible candidate to help us win in November!

BIPOC

Parrish, Christine R

LINCOLNVILLE

Collins has undermined our rights and squandered her power. We need a communicator who can focus on key issues and policies that affect Mainers on a daily basis, while standing firm on our constitutional rights. We need a candidate who is able to compromise to make pragmatic decisions while not sacrificing our democratic ideals. I do not have a particular candidate in mind. Here is what I can offer as a delegate and a foot soldier: As a journalist for 20 years, primarily in Maine (The Free Press, Village Soup, Public Radio International), I researched, investigated, and explained topics Mainers care about: elections (including a deep dive in redistricting), affordable housing, healthcare, homelessness, forestry, fisheries, environment, economic development, cops, courts, prison, drugs, domestic abuse, Maine's National Guard, and foreign policy. I even did political candidate profiles (LePage's favorite comic was Pop Eye). I've also served as a Democratic poll watcher, including at the Augusta Civic Center during the pandemic where I found false information on registering voters in the election worker training handbook (there was no reference to the legal option of a signed affidavit. It required ID). I'm patient and will talk to and listen to anyone's concerns to get out the Democratic vote -- including taking some time off from my conservation forestry job. My interviewing skills tend to yield results. Platner is gone. Sometimes short deadlines are best. We can grab headlines, focus, and keep the world's attention as we build momentum. Let's get 'er done!

Perkins, Nathaniel Bingham

WALDO

My name is Nathaniel Perkins, but everyone knows me as Ned. I'm a father of two, stepfather of three, and resident of Waldo. Many of you may recognize me from my work on the steering committee for Indivisible Waldo County, speaking at multiple No Kings protests in Belfast and Augusta, and leading teams of safety volunteers at those events and more. This primary season, 17,000 volunteers worked tirelessly for a campaign that won 72% of Maine's Democratic primary voters in order to build a movement larger than one man. We voted for a politics that values working Americans over wealth hoarding billionaires. We voted for universal health care, a progressive tax code, reproductive rights for women, ending corporate welfare, overturning Citizens' United, immigration reform that provides a path to citizenship, ending forever wars and genocide, strengthening unions, equality, and justice for all. I will consider three important factors when deciding which candidate(s) to support: Reflecting the will of Democrats and left-leaning independents of Waldo County, respecting the work of the volunteers who delivered an unprecedented landslide primary, and finding a candidate that can beat Susan Collins with a platform that promises real change that benefits the real people that call Maine home. This decision needs to be made by Mainers, for Mainers. I hope you will choose me as your

delegate. I will welcome and center all input from residents of Waldo County as I commit to voting for the best possible candidate in each round.

Pitkin, Forest

BELFAST

As an 18-year-old from Belfast, voting in the June 9th primary was my very first election, and it felt historic. Over 150,000 Mainers voted for a new kind of politics that represents everyday people, not the political establishment. Now, as we select a new nominee to defeat Susan Collins, we must protect that mandate. That is why I am running to be a Waldo County Delegate. We need a nominee who honors the independent, populist spirit of Platner's mandate but pairs it with pragmatic leadership. To beat Susan Collins, we cannot afford a platform that feels too radical or alienates working-class Mainers; instead, we need steady, unifying figures like Troy Jackson, Valli Geiger, and Nirav Shah who can build a broad coalition. I am looking for a candidate committed to practical, common-sense solutions that appeal to progressives, independents, and moderate Republicans alike. My promise to you is simple: I am here to listen. I have the time and drive this summer to hear your concerns and carry them directly to the convention. Whether you want to grab coffee locally or reach out to me directly at delegatepitkin@protonmail.com, I want to hear from you. I am also committed to reading and responding to emails sent to the delegate-wide email address. Regardless of your background or party, my goal is to ensure Waldo County's voice is heard. Let's build a coalition broad enough to win the general election and a politics practical enough to deliver for everyday people.

Pratt, Benjamin Marriner

SWANVILLE

I wish to be a delegate to represent the will of primary voters within the process afforded. I am an anti-fascist Union Firefighter/Paramedic and former state legislator. I served with Troy and worked on legislation with Shenna when she was with the ACLU. I am also impressed with Paige Loud. This is not the time for the same old traditional Democratic Party weak sauce "electable" candidate debate. We will be called Socialists and Communists regardless of who we nominate. We are at a crossroads and need a bold, aggressive and unapologetic stance. It is the POLICIES advocated, language used, and message delivered by the original Senate nominee that energized people, new and old. We cannot squander this enthusiasm for fear of a Collins win and downticket repercussions. Fight Fascism. Call out Genocide, refuse to fund it and the War Machine. Demand Universal Healthcare. Protect the Environment. Tax the Rich. Stand up for Workers and Unions. Get Money out of Politics. Codify Roe. Focus on housing and affordability. Reinvest in education. Refuse voter disenfranchisement. Reinvent Criminal Justice. Abolish ICE. Nominate a candidate that brings this Working Class agenda to the people and we can win. Hold Collins accountable for complicity in Trump's Fascist regime and refusal to engage with Mainers while getting rich. The economic system is rigged against workers and a new way forward is possible. I want to be part of a Democratic Party that rises to the occasion. All Power to the People! Solidarity Forever! No Pasaran!

Racine Currier, Amanda

WALDO

I am a mom of four. I am a student at Husson University in the psychology program. I see what this administration and Susan Collins are doing to our country. Susan Collins is an accomplice in the removal of rights from the people that we have long fought for. Her refusal to hear from her constituents is downright criminal. We need a strong candidate to face off against Collins and fight back against the illegal actions of the Republican Party. I believe in the platform Graham Platner was representing, so I aim to elect a candidate who shares those goals. As a delegate, I would elect a Senate candidate who aims to remove money from our politics and take back the country for the people. We, the people, mean everyone, no qualifications needed.

Reed, Cooper Thomas

SWANVILLE

Hello Maine Democrats, my name is Cooper Reed, and I seek your support to serve as a delegate to the nominating convention. This moment demands our unity and collective effort to forge a path forward based on our shared values. My journey in political activism began at 13 with the Waldo County Democrats, and I have consistently engaged in various political roles ever since. I've worked on behalf of candidates and ballot initiative campaigns like marriage equality and the protection of same-day voter registration and the clean elections program. For the past seven years, I've been proud to work with the Human Rights Campaign, the nation's largest LGBTQ+ civil rights organization. I remain dedicated to securing victories up and down the ballot, which is why I've taken on the role of Treasurer for two of our phenomenal state house candidates. As a young transgender dad in my early 30s, I offer a distinct perspective and take pride in my track record of fostering collaboration. The challenges ahead are significant, and it will require all of us to take action to unseat Susan Collins. We need to rally our friends, family, and neighbors, reaching out to them and addressing issues to meet the moment. I am committed to this effort because our lives and the future of our state are at stake. I hope to earn your support to serve as a delegate.

LGBTQIA+, Youth

Reid, Cynthia H

WINTERPORT

I am running to be a delegate to ensure we nominate a candidate that can win the general election in November and defeat Susan Collins once and for all. As a lifelong Democrat, I am excited for the opportunity to participate in this process and will take my responsibility as a voting delegate seriously. I spent nearly 50 years working in the human service field and have watched the systematic dismantling of programs and services to vulnerable individuals and families under Susan Collins watch. I recognize how much is at stake in the upcoming election and promise to do whatever I can to support our party's nominee.

Robie, Paul Edward

NORTHPORT

My top interests are climate change and health care; both of which should be managed for the public good rather than for profit. I believe there is a connection to the big money distorting our government: if we could provide health care for all and reduce reliance on fossil fuels there would be less incentive for these industries to defend their profits by buying politicians. I first registered as a Democrat during the first Trump administration when it became clear to me that our democracy was under threat. I have found that I can help the most when I work locally supporting candidates for the state legislature, for county government and for town offices. I often drive candidates doing doors including Chip Curry, Mike Ray, and Jan Dodge in past elections and recently Madison Cook and Cayla Miller. I see these candidates listening to their constituents, giving voters the power to speak directly to their representative. Supporting local candidates in this way gives Democrats a human sympathetic face which inspires voters who share our values a reason to vote. I am an old white man, retired merchant marine. I live in Northport. I believe that we need to defeat Susan Collins to protect our democracy and to get back to solving problems for the people of Maine.

Saggese, Vincent

BELFAST

I have lived in Waldo County since I was two years old, and I love this state with all my heart. Growing up in today's political climate has forced me to become very aware of the state of the country, and the role our corner plays in it. My grandma Scootch fostered a strong sense of civic duty in me, and I've always wanted to help determine the fate of my home. I am ready to engage in community outreach, creation of party strategy, and whatever it takes to ensure we score big wins this election. Susan Collins has continually disappointed her constituents in Congress and I want nothing more than to see her sent home. All Maine needs is a strong candidate to oppose her, and I think I have a good head for picking those out.

LGBTQIA+

Sanders, Eric Finnis

BELFAST

Hi, I would very much like to be a delegate. I think it is imperative that we defeat Susan Collins. I would vote for a telephone pole if I had to. I always say try to learn from the past and move forward and that's what I'm asking us all to do with Graham Platner and his campaign. I think you need his supporters, and the best way to keep the movement alive and growing is to incorporate his policies into the next candidate. I find Troy Jackson to be compelling as he is from Aroostook County. He also shares many if not all of Platner's platform, and has their early support. I find Shenna Bellows to be compelling because she stood up to Trump more than once in her role with the state. And she closely was defeated in rank choice voting. I am open minded and I am a good listener and I would definitely listen

to everything the candidates say between now and at the convention. Whoever is chosen must appeal to as many sections of the State as possible. Thank you for your consideration.

Shaw, Ethan Alexander

LINCOLNVILLE

I will perform my duties as delegate to represent the interests of Waldo County Democratic voters to the best of my abilities. We are in a tough spot but I still believe we can defeat Collins if we stay true to the will of the voters. I promise to listen to and represent the people of Waldo County.

Shell, Susan H

MONTVILLE

I am a longtime resident of Montville. During my 40+ years here, I have been actively involved in our community in a number of ways: serving on the town's Budget Committee, Appeals Board, and Planning Board as well as on the boards of several community non-profit organizations. My political involvement has included managing and volunteering for campaigns, organizing voter registration drives, and serving for many years as the Montville Democratic Town Chair. I spent nine years serving as Town Administrator in Montville. Working in the town office exposed me to the needs of western Waldo County. I think it's crucial that this part of our county has a voice in selecting the nominee. I have not yet committed to supporting a particular candidate. If selected as a delegate, I will welcome and carefully consider the perspectives of Waldo County Democrats while also taking the time to thoroughly evaluate each candidate on my own. I will want to hear which candidate you support—and why—as well as your thoughts on the qualities and priorities that are most important in selecting the strongest candidate to challenge Susan Collins. Who can build on the energy and excitement generated by the Platner campaign while appealing to the wide range of voters we need to beat Susan Collins? I am someone who takes the time to listen, gather information, and carefully weigh the facts before making an important decision, and I would approach my role as a delegate with that same sense of responsibility.

Sirota, Michael J

SEARSMONT

Providing a successful opponent to defeat Susan Collins in November should be a Democratic priority. I am informed, connected to people in Waldo County, old enough to be knowledgeable and pragmatic, young enough to be energized. I can support the chosen nominee and offer a household to increase voter turnout. Retired, I have the time to participate now and through the election.

Slegona, Cyrene

BELFAST

I believe now more than ever before it is our responsibility to show up and speak on behalf of the people of Maine of our country. We must put aside small differences and focus on issues of major importance and ways to address them that protect and strengthen are democracy.

Smith, Melissa Anne

MONROE

Fellow WC Dems: I believe Troy Jackson best aligns with the progressive platform we voted for, and with our support, Troy can win! He's the only one of these candidates endorsed by Bernie and the Maine AFL-CIO. In June, Troy won Portland, Bangor and Augusta; in the legislature, he consistently won in deep red Senate District 1 in the County. This is not a do-over of the Primary; we have an obligation to honor the voters who overwhelmingly said we want a pro-working class, progressive platform in our Senate candidate. This is an incredible movement of working-class people taking back power and demanding change. The candidate we select must want money out of politics, Medicare for all, to end funding Israel, free Palestine, reproductive and LGBTQ rights, affordable housing and food, and workers' right to form a union. Troy is that candidate. About me: I've lived in Monroe for 11 years and spent every summer growing up at our (former) camp on Sebec Lake; Maine has always been home. My grandparents retired to Monson; my parents retired to Monroe. I work at a small grassroots nonprofit, I'm a union member and am very active in Maine's labor movement. I vote in every election and actively support candidates that align with my progressive values. I hope you'll select me as a delegate. I'll do whatever I can to help defeat Susan Collins, supporting whichever candidate we choose. We can't mess this up; the whole country is watching. Let's retire Susan.

Smith, Zachary Albert

BELFAST

I intend to serve as a Waldo County delegate because it is increasingly important that people become involved in local and grassroots politics. We must harness and build on the progressive and humanist momentum that has been growing in our state in recent months. This is important because of the many obstacles and impediments that we currently face. ICE is patrolling our streets with unchecked and reckless abandon, corporate entities are sewing division and confusion while ruthlessly depleting our environment, and Mainers are being priced out of their communities and becoming increasingly incapable of keeping their lights on and putting food on their tables. Graham Platner provided a brief but inspiring bit of hope against these challenges. His effective talking points and forceful rhetorical style made Maine Democrats believe for a moment that someone was going to stand up for them. To effectively take the fight to the political establishment and economic elites who are currently ravaging our country for their own gain. But Mr. Platner was finally an embarrassment to our state and our party. His hubris about what he could keep in his past deceived himself and simultaneously

deceived his voters. It is important that we continue to build on the political coalition that Mr. Platner was able to establish, run with courage and determination, and not succumb to the flaws that finally brought one man down. It is time for the adults to take control of this movement. I intend to be one of them.

Snow, Jamie Leone

WINTERPORT

The favorite pastime of Mainers is complaining. It's too cold, it's too hot, there are too many tourists, there aren't enough tourists, lobster is too expensive, not enough people are buying lobster. While I also love to partake in a good complaining session, there comes a time when one needs to buck up or shut up. Susan Collins is no longer serving her people and it is time to completely remove her from equation. My contribution to the forward movement of the Democratic party here in Maine is the iteral continuance of it with the raising my children with compassion, knowledge of how local government works and how to care and protect their neighbors. Participating in local government is a duty and a privilege. I am no longer willing to sit by and let the history of our state be decided without being in the room.

LGBTQIA+, Youth

Stark, Lauren E W

BELFAST

My name is Lauren Stark, and I am a Belfast resident, parent, and longtime progressive educator and organizer. If selected as a delegate to the Nominating Convention, I would bring my experience advancing democracy and justice through policy research, critical education, and community organizing. As an engaged community member in Belfast, I am committed to using research, writing, and horizontalist organizing to build a world where everyone can flourish. In the last five years, this has included collaborating to organize a Resistance Faire to support community building and political education, writing op-eds and reports that support social equity and the care economy, teaching a course on critical education, canvassing for progressive political candidates, leading a banned book PRIDE event, serving on the Belfast Free Library Board of Trustees, and facilitating Belfast's Better Worlds Book Club at Left Bank Books. If I am elected, I see my role as supporting the will of the Waldo County meeting members and the "Maine People Powered Movement" platform. Beyond democratically representing my neighbors at the convention, I will help defeat Susan Collins in November by collaborating with my fellow Mainers to canvas, educate, and organize for a progressive candidate.

Suggs, Alexander

BELFAST

For all his faults, Graham Platner pushed the Democratic party in Maine to the left and built incredible momentum because of it. As a blue collar democrat, and hopefully as a delegate, I would love the opportunity to be one of 601 voices continuing this push to the left as it is likely the only path to defeating Susan Collins and restoring some sanity to our country.

Swift, Pamela Jo

PALERMO

Graham Platner had the right message: to bring the power back to the people, to create a government that works to make all of our lives better, and to force corporations and the wealthy to pay their fair share. Democrats want Medicare for All, affordable childcare, affordable housing, excellent schools, debt-free college, and decreased cost for prescription medications. In short, everyday Mainers want to live a high quality of life with dignity and have a government that works for them. Graham lit the fire in the base and created a movement. He set the table, but now it's our opportunity to nominate a candidate that can take us across the finish line. We must vote Susan Collins out. She has abandoned Mainers on so many levels. As scary as our political climate currently is with this madman in the White House and a cowardly, supplicant GOP Congress and Supreme Court, we need to recognize this for the opportunity it is—the opportunity to create a society that raises us all. I'd like to stand up and run for Delegate in this historic moment to help us navigate our way to a better tomorrow. We all do better when we all do better.

Tate, Valerie

BELFAST

I'm the vice chair of the Waldo County Democratic Committee. I live in Belfast. I was an RN at an inner city hospital and became an organizer and labor leader of nurses. I retired as the Coordinator of the Nurse Alliance of SEIU Healthcare. I am also on the Board of the Belfast Community Co-op. I previously served as Chair of WCDC's Campaign Committee and as an Executive Committee member for several years. I consider myself a progressive Democrat and would advocate for the platform that the movement that lately was led by Graham Platner also supports.

Underrepresented Religion

Temple, Haydee

LINCOLNVILLE

As a young (20-year-old) woman of color and an immigrant, I would like to see diversity within Waldo County's delegates. I support Healthcare for All, Women's Reproductive Rights, DEI, tax fairness, and Human Rights for all - especially trans and indigenous people. I don't support Endless Wars or ICE. I want a Senator who refuses to fund the destruction of Gaza and instead funds education, a pathway to citizenship, Social Security, and the post office. I'm also a big fan of protecting Maine's environment, unions, good-paying jobs, our working waterfront, our forest, and our small businesses. I want our next senator to stand up for those of us with disabilities, to help those of us struggling to find childcare or housing. At this point, I plan to support progressive Troy Jackson as our nominee and hope those who also support him will select me as a delegate. I want to ensure we nominate a candidate for the Senate through a process that is as democratic as possible and respects the will of the voters. Given the highly unusual circumstances, Democrats cannot afford a situation that appears compromised by backroom deals or excessive party influence. I appreciate everything that party leadership has done so far to facilitate the smoothest and most transparent process possible. If selected, I will make myself available in person, by phone, and by email to hear from all Mainers - including unenrolled voters - about who they believe would be the best candidate to guarantee Democrats win

BIPOC, Disability, Youth

Temple, Jennifer M

LINCOLNVILLE

I am a 52-year-old white woman working from home for a small construction company. I'm politically active and passionate about social justice. I believe in the Constitution, human rights, and equal protection under the law. I think Troy Jackson is best positioned to end Susan Collins' 30-year US Senate run. He truly represents the needs of all Mainers, regardless of political affiliation. Troy agrees that the genocide in Gaza is unconscionable and that America has the power to end it. He supports tribal sovereignty and Medicare for All, and he puts our needs over corporations and billionaires. As Maine Senate President, he fought to lower prescription drug prices, pass universal school meals, protect union jobs, expand rural health care, deliver property tax relief, safeguard our environment, and pass laws that put power back in the hands of working Mainers — all while consistently winning elections in our district, which went for both Donald Trump and Susan Collins. As a mother, I'm a good listener who considers all viewpoints as I make decisions I believe will benefit everyone involved. I'll use this approach as a delegate for Waldo County. At the convention, I'll represent both those of us who voted in the primary and those who didn't. If selected, I will make myself widely available over the next week to hear from anyone who reaches out. I'll work tirelessly to get a progressive Maine Democrat elected to the US Senate. I'll recruit others, fundraise and share my time and talents.

Tingle, Amy

NORTHPORT

I am interested in becoming a delegate for the Nominating Convention because I want to be part of the solution and actively participate in the system where I want to see change. The Democratic party in Maine is in a very vulnerable position with an abrupt change in candidates midstream and so close to the election. I would like to do everything in my power to be the positive change I want to see in the world. This seems like a good step forward toward understanding the process and helping to nominate an electable candidate who can beat Susan Collins in November. It takes every one of us to do what we feel comfortable doing and this one piece I know I can do.

LGBTQIA+

Tirrell, Janelle

PALERMO

Now is certainly the time for all good Democrats to come to the aid of the party. This choice is critical to winning back the Senate and must not be marred by bad blood. We have no time to lick our wounds. Now is the time to stand up and be counted.

Tirrell, Stephen

PALERMO

I would be honored to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I view the 2026 elections as critical to the existence of the United States as a functional democracy. We must wrest control of our society from fascists and oligarchs. I would volunteer to assist in the effort to defeat Senator Collins. I could act as a go-fer, assist in some information technology capacity, canvass door-to-door, or make phone calls. If there is some simple task, I could complete it. If there is a complex task, I could assist. It is vital to communicate to the people of Maine how stark the choice is that we face in November. Again, I would go door-to-door and call our fellow Mainers to encourage them to support a candidate who would oppose the current idiotic and unlawful war. I would help reach out to people so they might understand that only the Democratic candidate would assist in solutions for affordable health care, an affordable cost of living, and an affordable place to live. I want to preserve our democracy and our civil society. I would like to find a way to help.

Townsend, Hubert Cameron

BELFAST

My name is Hugh Townsend. I'm a native and resident of Belfast and a 12th generation Mainer. Over nearly the past decade, I've been an active member of the Belfast Planning Board and Harbor Advisory Committee, the Friends of the Hutchinson Center Committee and other community

organizations in Waldo County. I'd like to serve as a delegate at the Nominating Convention to contribute in person to the selection of a worthy Democrat candidate with the greatest likelihood of defeating Susan Collins in November. Helping defeat Susan Collins begins with nominating the best candidate. We have several highly qualified candidates who could each be an effective Senator. I'll be looking for the candidate who best expresses the value of their candidacy to Maine citizens and demonstrates the values, experience, energy and communication abilities to take the fight to Collins and win. Once our candidate is chosen at the Nominating Convention, I will work to get that candidate elected, including canvassing as I've done in the past and other activities that may be needed. Our party will continue to build its grassroots momentum if it exposes Collins's record for what it is and provides a compelling alternative and vision for Maine voters. It will be up to our chosen candidate to lead and the rest of us, including me, to rally support in this effort.

Trites, Donald G

LINCOLNVILLE

As a lifelong Democrat and a registered voter in Lincolnville for 21 years, I believe in the issues of tax fairness, Medicare for all, open process in all Democratic practices. As an 84 year old who has seen the corruption for many years, a PhD who has studied our history and an active supporter of disability rights, I will work all around Waldo County to ensure the defeat of our failed US Senator.

Tucker, Kimberly J

LINCOLNVILLE

As an attorney who has practiced constitutional law for most of my 40+ year legal career, I understand that there has never been a more urgent need for every one of us to defend our Constitution and the rights of all people in this country – whether they are our fellow citizens or people wishing to come to this country for a better life. I am committed to the principles that Our Revolution stands for and voted for Graham Platner in the primary. I support and appreciate Graham's decision to withdraw, but believe that our new candidate MUST have a demonstrated record in Maine of commitment to the priorities that Graham Platner's supporters voted to adopt as priorities: (1) improving the lives and protecting the livelihoods of, working people in Maine and beyond; (2) providing good and affordable healthcare to everyone in this country by adopting Medicare for All; (3) preserving our rural hospitals and restoring OB-GYN services everywhere (including getting hedge funders out of healthcare); (4) reforming the U.S. Supreme Court; (5) restoring the reproductive freedom of all women in the country; (6) protecting Maine's working waterfront and our lobstermen and fishermen's traditions and fishing grounds; (7) restoring the affordability of life, housing, and food in Maine and the nation; (8) restoring the sovereignty of Maine's indigenous people; (9) preserving Penobscot Bay and Sears Island from industrialization and restoring the island's Wabanaki name (Wahsumkik); (10) protecting our nation's immigrants and asylum seekers, abolishing ICE; and (11) promoting labor unions.

Vargas, Carolina

WINTERPORT

I would like to serve as a delegate to the Nominating Convention because I believe it is important that the voices of all Maine Democrats are represented and that the selection process is transparent and trusted. As a Latina, I want to help ensure that Maine's Latin American community feels heard, engaged, and connected to our party. I want to be someone who can communicate information back to the community and encourage more people to participate in our democratic process. I also bring a unique perspective through my work. I have a Ph.D. in Agricultural Economics and work with farmers and agricultural communities across the country. Through that work, I have seen firsthand the challenges facing rural communities and the importance of making sure their voices are part of the conversation. Much of my work involves listening to people with different perspectives and helping find common ground, and I believe those skills can help strengthen our party. To help defeat Susan Collins in November, I plan to continue engaging directly with the community, especially Latino voters and rural residents, listening to their concerns and encouraging participation. I have been active with local organizations and volunteer groups in Waldo County and will continue supporting grassroots outreach wherever needed. I also believe it is important to combat misinformation by sharing accurate information and helping build trust in both our candidates and our democratic processes. By continuing to organize, listen, and engage, we can build on the momentum that has energized Mainers.

Walker, Valerie Lynn

FRANKFORT

Susan needs to go she only votes for the people when it won't affect the outcome the republicans want.

Disability

Walls, Dawn Rose

BELFAST

My name is Dawn Walls. I was born and raised in Maine. This is my home and I am passionate about helping it be the best it can possibly be, as well as lifting up this country. I have been a delegate to our democratic state conventions since 2020. I chose to get involved at that level at that time, because it was clear to me that the process was just not representing me or my neighbors. I was no longer able to sit on the sidelines and let others make decisions that were important and impactful to me and my family. I have remained involved in myriad ways; supporting candidates, testifying before the legislature, letter writing, protesting, and more. It is imperative that our state continues to hold the line and this country continues to resist the imperial and fascist inclinations of our current administration. We need legislators who are strong in defense of our freedoms and rights. I am definitely Progressive and not afraid of that word. So, at this pivotal time I am completely committed to representing the voters of Maine, who chose overwhelmingly the candidate who was most closely aligned with

Progressive values. Out of this bizarre and outrageous mess we have this opportunity to again have our voices heard and make our votes count! I would love to represent your vote. Thank you for your consideration!

Disability

Walters, Deborah K W

FRANKFORT

Our urgent goal is to UNITE Mainers to defeat Susan Collins. 72% of voters in the primary demonstrated a clear preference for Graham Platner's platform focused on creating a government that works for working people, rather than for corporations and billionaires. That campaign inspired and organized thousands of volunteers, including me, Deb Walters. I served on the grass-roots-driven platform committee. We should elect the candidate whose platform is the best fit with Platner's platform: to honor the voices of the primary voters, and to harness the energy of the thousands of already organized dem and unenrolled volunteers. We should elect a candidate with a proven ability to be elected in Republican leaning areas of Maine, and with demonstrated legislative leadership skills: to help attract the 20% of primary voters who voted for Mills, and to attract more unenrolled and Republican voters. Electing a candidate with a 100% rating from Planned Parenthood for legislative advocacy and a perfect voting record would help us: to campaign for federal legalization of reproductive rights. Electing a candidate with undisputed working class experience would help: to recruit even more working class voters to return to the Democratic Party. The failures of our current presidential administration have become glaringly obvious, which gives us an extraordinary opportunity to finally say "Good-bye, Susan", and to continue to grow a movement to hold our politicians accountable! (I have previously served as the delegate to the Democratic Convention from my small town of Frankfort.)

Webb, Andrew Aidan

BELFAST

Call me Aidan. I came to Maine for college 30 years ago, and stayed. I have visited most states, but Maine is where I found my wife, and where we've made our home. We love our land, animals, and care deeply for the well-being of our community and beyond. It was NOT my idea to put in to be a delegate. My brother suggested it because, "why not you?" I could think of no reason but apathy, and that is unacceptable today. I don't want this responsibility, but no one should. Action is required to remove Collins. We need representatives who have strength of conviction to not just voice "concerns"- about rights of women, minorities, and the rest of us. They must protect those rights with every vote, and keep their word given to all Mainers. I am not always right, but I treasure integrity and candor. I can listen to what our candidates, evaluate their deeds, and make a sober decision about their ability to defeat Susan Collins. I can because I have seen depravity of individuals in this current administration beyond what I ever expected from our politics, and now recognize the smell. I will vote for a candidate with integrity and candor enough to represent Maine.

brown, annie Fitzmaurice

LINCOLNVILLE

I have not served as a delegate before, but would like to be considered. I am a well-informed voter formerly unaffiliated voter who has been registered and participating in Waldo County since 2016. I am an electoral process nerd, professional administrator, and am prepared and excited to lean in and make this work for the best result for us all. Thank you for working so hard to set up this emergency convention, it must be a daunting task!

silverman, Elias B

BELFAST

As an active lifelong Democrat, I would very much like to participate in this important and crucial candidate selection for our party's US Senate candidate. I view this process as a continuation of my previous participation in this year's Maine Democratic State convention in May and in the convention 2 years ago. In addition, I have knocked on doors for Democratic candidates on the National, State and local levels as well as addressing letters to Democratic voters. My prime unifying concern is to replace Susan Collins with a Democrat. In this regard, I believe Democrats should nominate a candidate who can command a wide swath of Maine voters. To accomplish this, I believe the party should reflect, incorporate and build upon the enthusiasm and activity of those who voted in the Democratic primary. At the same time, I believe we should be cautious in applying detailed litmus tests for our candidate so that he/ she is not restricted in their campaign for this important election which very well might be integral to Democratic control of the US Senate. Last, and certainly not least, my motivation is fueled by my desire to give something back to Maine which has been very good to my family. I have also been particularly impressed by the openness, decorum and congeniality of the Waldo County and Maine Democratic party. I wish to continue this connection and campaign wholeheartedly for our party's nominee.

tackel, susan

BELFAST

We moved to Belfast in 2021. I did three things----joined the Y, the Library and the Waldo County Democrats. I immediately volunteered to work on Jared Golden's reelection campaign, writing postcards, knocking on doors and making phone calls. In 2008, I travelled to an all-white neighborhood in Pennsylvania asking people to vote for a Black man for President. Postcards and phone calls followed. I have been a delegate to the last 2 Maine Democratic conventions—in Bangor and more recently Portland. As a lifelong Democratic I believed in LBJ and his Great Society including the right to vote and fair representation. I am a centrist but will do whatever it takes to unseat Susan Collins.